M E I T Y A I C Y B E R P R O J E C T

Objective 1: Standardisation of Cybersecurity Audit Report Format

USER MANUAL

AI-Assisted Cybersecurity Audit Report Standardisation System

1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose of This Manual

This User Manual provides complete step-by-step guidance for operating the AI-Assisted Cybersecurity Audit Report Standardisation System developed under Objective 1 of the MEITY AI Cyber Project. The system enables auditors, reviewers, and authorised personnel to upload cybersecurity audit reports in various formats and obtain a uniform, machine-readable, source-traceable standardised output. This manual is intended to help end-users understand the system's capabilities, navigate its interface, submit audit reports, interpret extracted outputs, handle common issues, and follow best practices for consistent usage.

1.2 Background and Context

Cybersecurity audit reports submitted by different auditing agencies vary widely in structure, terminology, severity classification, evidence presentation, and formatting. Reports may arrive as PDF documents, Word files, scanned images, Excel annexures, plain text, screenshots, or logs. This heterogeneity makes it difficult to search, compare, benchmark, and evaluate reports in a consistent and automated manner.

Objective 1 addresses this challenge by:

- Defining a Standard Audit Report Template with mandatory and optional fields, controlled vocabularies, section order, evidence requirements, and field descriptions.
- Developing a Machine-Readable JSON/XML Schema representing the standardised report structure.
- Building an offline hybrid pipeline — combining rule-based parsing and AI/NLP-based extraction that converts unstructured or semi-structured reports into the standard schema.

1.3 Scope

This manual covers the following system functions accessible to authorised users:

- Secure upload of cybersecurity audit reports in supported formats.
- Automated OCR, text extraction, table extraction, and evidence linking.
- AI-assisted synonym mapping and entity extraction.
- Viewing and downloading the structured standardised output (JSON/XML).
- Reviewing source traceability information for each extracted field.
- Basic troubleshooting and error handling.

1.4 Intended Audience

User Role	Primary Responsibility
Cybersecurity Auditors	Upload audit reports, review standardised outputs, verify traceability.
Audit Reviewers / QA Officers	Review structured outputs, validate extracted fields, add reviewer comments.
Project Administrators	Manage system configuration, user access, and report versioning.
System Operators	Monitor pipeline health, handle file processing errors.
Stakeholder Evaluators	View standardised reports and comparison outputs for governance.

1.5 How to Use This Manual

This manual is organised sequentially. First-time users should read all sections in order. Experienced users may navigate directly to the relevant section using the Table of Contents. Important notices are highlighted in coloured boxes throughout the document.

NOTE
All references to system screens, menu labels, and button names in this manual correspond to the current Version 1.0 of the system interface. Screen layouts may vary slightly depending on the deployment environment.

2. System Overview

2.1 What the System Does

The AI-Assisted Cybersecurity Audit Report Standardisation System is an offline, air-gap-compatible platform that accepts cybersecurity audit reports in heterogeneous formats and transforms them into a uniform, structured, machine-readable format. The system combines deterministic rule-based parsing with AI/NLP-based extraction to handle the wide variety of terminologies, structures, and writing styles used by different auditing agencies.

2.2 Key Functionalities

- Multi-format report ingestion: PDF, DOCX, TXT, XLSX, scanned images, screenshots, and logs.
- File validation, hashing (SHA-256), and malware scanning workflow.
- OCR processing for scanned and image-based documents.
- Rule-based parsing for dates, CVE/CWE/CVSS identifiers, severity labels, IP addresses, and standard headings.
- AI/NLP-based entity extraction and synonym mapping (e.g., 'Findings', 'Observations', 'Issues Identified' → standard 'Vulnerability Findings' section).
- Table and evidence (screenshot, log, annexure) extraction and linking.
- Source-traceable structured output (JSON/XML) with page, section, and paragraph references.
- Downloadable standardised report in JSON, XML, and human-readable formats.

2.3 System Architecture — High-Level Overview

The system operates as a pipeline with the following sequential stages:

Stage No.	Stage Name	Description
1	Secure Upload	User uploads the audit report through the system interface.
2	File Validation & Hashing	File type is validated; SHA-256 hash is computed for integrity.
3	Malware Scan Workflow	File is passed through the configured malware scanning component.
4	OCR (if applicable)	Scanned/image-based documents are processed through the OCR engine.
5	Text & Table Extraction	Structured text, tables, and embedded objects are extracted.
6	Section Detection	Document sections are detected using rule-based and AI methods.
7	Field Extraction	Key entities (vulnerability name, severity, CVE, etc.) are extracted.
8	Schema Mapping	Extracted fields are mapped to the standard JSON/XML schema.
9	Evidence Linking	Findings are linked with supporting screenshots, logs, and tables.
10	Source Traceability	Each extracted field is tagged with its source location.
11	Output Generation	Standardised structured report is generated and made available.

2.4 Supported Input Formats

Format	Description
PDF (.pdf)	Native text-based and scanned/image PDFs.
Word Document (.docx, .doc)	Microsoft Word audit report documents.
Plain Text (.txt)	Text-based audit logs and report exports.
Excel Annexure (.xlsx, .xls)	Vulnerability tables and annexure spreadsheets.
Scanned Document / Image	JPEG, PNG, TIFF images of audit pages — OCR applied.
Screenshot Files	Evidence screenshots embedded or submitted separately.
Log Files (.log, .txt)	Tool output and system logs accompanying audit reports.

2.5 Standard Output Schema — Summary

The system produces a structured output aligned with the Standard Cybersecurity Audit Report Schema. The output contains the following top-level sections:

- Report Metadata (report ID, date, version, hash, traceability reference)
- Audit Type and Domain
- Audited Organisation Details
- Auditing Agency Details
- Audit Scope, Objectives, and Methodology
- Assets Covered and Exclusions
- Tools Used
- Vulnerability Findings (with CVE/CWE/CVSS, severity, affected assets, evidence links)
- Recommendations and Remediation Priority
- Compliance / Control Mapping
- Executive Summary and Technical Summary
- Conclusion, Reviewer Comments, Approval Status

3. Getting Started

3.1 Prerequisites

Before using the system, ensure the following conditions are met:

Requirement	Details
System Access	You must have valid credentials (username and password) issued by the Project Administrator.
Supported Browser	Use the latest version of Mozilla Firefox or Chromium-based browsers on the deployed internal network.
Network	The system operates on a closed, air-gapped internal network. No internet connection is required or permitted during operation.
File Readiness	Ensure your audit report file is complete, not password-protected, and in a supported format (see Section 2.4).
File Size Limit	Individual files must not exceed 100 MB. For larger submissions, contact the System Administrator.
Access Role	Confirm your assigned role with the Administrator — Auditor, Reviewer, or Admin — as different roles have different access permissions.

3.2 Accessing the System

1. Open your web browser on the internal network terminal.
2. Navigate to the system URL provided by your Project Administrator (e.g., http://[internal-server-address]/audit-std/).
3. You will see the Login Page. Enter your Username and Password in the respective fields.
4. Click the Log In button.
5. On first login, you will be prompted to change your default password. Set a strong password of at least 12 characters including uppercase, lowercase, numbers, and special characters.
6. After successful login, you will land on the System Dashboard.

SECURITY NOTICE

Never share your login credentials with anyone. Do not write your password on paper or store it in an unsecured digital file. Log out immediately after completing your session by clicking the Logout button at the top-right corner of every page.

3.3 System Dashboard Overview

The System Dashboard is the main navigation hub. It contains the following sections:

Dashboard Section	Description
Upload New Report	Submit a new cybersecurity audit report for processing.
My Reports	View, track, and download previously submitted and processed reports.
Standardised Outputs	Access generated structured JSON/XML outputs for processed reports.
Traceability Viewer	Review source traceability for each extracted field.
System Notifications	View system messages, processing status updates, and alerts.
Help / Documentation	Access the User Manual, FAQs, and quick-reference guides.
Admin Panel	Visible only to Administrator role — manage users, configurations, and report schema versions.

4. Uploading an Audit Report

4.1 Step-by-Step Upload Process

Follow the steps below to submit an audit report for standardisation:

Step 1 — Navigate to Upload

From the Dashboard, click the Upload New Report button (blue button, top-left of the main panel). You will be directed to the Upload Report page.

Step 2 — Enter Report Metadata

Before attaching the file, complete the required metadata fields:

Field	Type	Description / Example
Report Title	Mandatory	A descriptive title for the report (e.g., 'VAPT Report – Org XYZ – Aug 2026').
Audit Type	Mandatory	Select from dropdown: VAPT, Network Infrastructure, Mobile Application Security, Web Application Security, Others.
Audited Organisation Name	Mandatory	Full legal name of the organisation being audited.
Auditing Agency Name	Mandatory	Full name of the agency that conducted the audit.
Report Date	Mandatory	Date of the original audit report (DD/MM/YYYY format).
Submission Date	Auto-filled	Auto-populated with today's date.
Report Language	Optional	Language of the submitted report (default: English).
Additional Notes	Optional	Any context the reviewer needs to know about this submission.

Step 3 — Attach the Report File

Click the Choose File button or drag and drop your audit report file into the upload area. The system accepts files up to 100 MB. If your submission includes multiple files (e.g., a main report plus Excel annexures and screenshot folders), use the Add Additional Files button to attach all related files under one submission.

NOTE

If attaching multiple files for a single audit (e.g., main report + annexures + screenshots), always upload them under one submission so the system can cross-reference evidence across files. Separate submissions will be treated as independent reports.

Step 4 — Select Processing Options

Choose the processing options applicable to your submission:

Option	Description
Enable OCR	Select if the file contains scanned pages or image-based content. If unsure, leave enabled — OCR is applied only where needed.
Extract Tables	Enabled by default. Deselect only if you know the report has no tabular data.
Extract Screenshots / Evidence	Enabled by default. Extracts embedded screenshots, diagrams, and tool outputs.
Strict Schema Validation	Enable to flag any extracted field that does not have sufficient confidence. Recommended for final submissions.
Output Format	Select JSON, XML, or Both (default: Both).

Step 5 — Submit for Processing

Click the Submit Report button. The system will:

7. Validate the file type and check that the file is not corrupted.
8. Compute a SHA-256 hash of the uploaded file and display it on-screen. Record this hash for future verification.
9. Pass the file through the malware scanning workflow.
10. Queue the file for pipeline processing.

You will receive a Submission Reference Number (SRN) upon successful submission. Note this number — it is used to track, retrieve, and reference your report throughout the system.

SUCCESS

A green confirmation banner with your Submission Reference Number (SRN) will appear at the top of the page upon successful submission. If you see a red error banner, refer to Section 7 (Troubleshooting) of this manual.

4.2 Monitoring Processing Status

After submission, you can monitor the processing status of your report under My Reports on the Dashboard. The status column will display one of the following values:

Status	Meaning
Queued	Report has been received and is waiting in the processing queue.
Validating	File type and integrity validation is in progress.
Scanning	Malware scanning workflow is running.
OCR Processing	OCR is being applied to scanned/image content.
Extracting	Text, table, and evidence extraction is in progress.
AI Processing	AI/NLP-based section detection, entity extraction, and synonym mapping are running.
Schema Mapping	Extracted fields are being mapped to the standard schema.
Completed	Processing is complete. Structured output is ready for review and download.
Failed	Processing encountered an unrecoverable error. See Section 7 for guidance.
Flagged	Report was flagged by the malware scanner. No output is generated. Contact Administrator.

5. Viewing and Understanding the Standardised Output

5.1 Accessing the Standardised Output

Once processing status shows Completed, navigate to My Reports and click the View Output button next to your report. You will be taken to the Standardised Output Viewer page.

5.2 Output Viewer Layout

The Output Viewer is divided into three panels:

- Left Panel — Table of Contents: Lists all sections of the standardised report. Click any section to jump to it.
- Centre Panel — Structured Report View: Displays the standardised report in a human-readable format, section by section.
- Right Panel — Source Traceability: When you click any field or finding, this panel shows its source reference (file name, page number, section, paragraph, or table from the original uploaded document).

5.3 Key Sections of the Standardised Output

The standardised output is organised into the following sections. All sections correspond to the Standard Cybersecurity Audit Report Schema:

5.3.1 Report Metadata

Displays system-generated and user-provided metadata including:

- Submission Reference Number (SRN)
- Original Report Title and Date
- Submission Date and Processing Completion Timestamp
- SHA-256 File Hash (for integrity verification)
- Audit Type and Domain
- Schema Version used for standardisation

5.3.2 Audited Organisation and Auditing Agency Details

Shows extracted information about the organisation being audited and the agency that conducted the audit, including contact details, registration information, and accreditation status where available.

5.3.3 Audit Scope, Objectives, and Methodology

Presents the extracted audit scope (systems, applications, networks covered), stated audit objectives, and the methodology employed by the auditing agency (e.g., black-box, grey-box, white-box; manual vs. automated; tools used).

5.3.4 Assets Covered and Exclusions

Lists all identified assets covered under the audit (IP addresses, hostnames, application URLs, mobile apps, network segments) and any explicitly stated exclusions or limitations.

5.3.5 Tools Used

Lists all auditing tools identified in the report (e.g., Nessus, Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, Nmap, Metasploit, custom scripts).

5.3.6 Vulnerability Findings

This is the core section of the standardised output. Each finding is presented as a structured record containing:

Field	Description
Finding ID	Auto-generated unique identifier for each vulnerability finding.
Vulnerability Name	Standardised name of the vulnerability (normalised from various agency terminologies).
Vulnerability Description	Full extracted description of the vulnerability.
Severity	Standardised severity level: Critical, High, Medium, Low, or Informational.
Affected Asset / Component	Specific IP address, hostname, URL, application, or component affected.
Affected Endpoint	Specific endpoint, port, parameter, or API path where applicable.
CVE Identifier	CVE ID if referenced in the original report (e.g., CVE-2024-12345).
CWE Identifier	CWE ID mapped to the vulnerability type (e.g., CWE-89 for SQL Injection).
CVSS Score & Vector	CVSS score and vector string if available in the original report.
Evidence References	Links to associated screenshots, log entries, tool outputs, or table entries.
Recommendation	Extracted or AI-inferred remediation recommendation.
Remediation Priority	High / Medium / Low priority for remediation action.
Compliance / Control Mapping	Mapped compliance reference (e.g., ISO 27001 control, NIST CSF, OWASP Top 10).
Source Traceability	Page number, section, paragraph, or table in the original report where this finding originates.

5.3.7 Executive Summary and Technical Summary

Displays the extracted executive summary (suitable for management review) and the technical summary (detailed findings overview for technical staff).

5.3.8 Conclusion and Reviewer Fields

Shows the extracted conclusion from the original report along with fields for reviewer comments (editable by authorised Reviewer role users) and approval status.

5.4 Interpreting Confidence Indicators

Each extracted field is accompanied by a confidence indicator showing how reliably the system extracted that field:

Indicator	Meaning
High Confidence (≥ 85%)	Field was extracted with high certainty — typically from clearly structured, labelled content in the source document.
Medium Confidence (60–84%)	Field was extracted with reasonable certainty — AI-assisted inference was used. Human verification is recommended.
Low Confidence (< 60%)	Field was extracted with low certainty — significant ambiguity or poor source formatting was encountered. Human review and correction is mandatory before finalisation.
Not Found	The field could not be extracted from the source document. The field may not have been present in the original report.

IMPORTANT: Low-confidence ( ) and Not Found ( ) fields must be reviewed and, where necessary, manually corrected or filled by the authorised Reviewer before the standardised output is finalised and approved. Do not approve an output with unresolved red-confidence fields

6. Reviewing, Editing, and Approving the Output

6.1 Who Can Review and Edit

Users with the Reviewer or Administrator role can review, edit, and approve standardised outputs. Auditor-role users can view outputs but cannot modify or approve them.

6.2 Editing Extracted Fields

11. Open the Standardised Output Viewer for the report you wish to review (My Reports → View Output).
12. Click the Edit button at the top-right of the centre panel. The panel switches to Edit Mode.
13. Click any field to edit it. A text box or dropdown will appear depending on the field type.
14. Make the necessary corrections. All manual edits are logged with your username, timestamp, and a before/after record.
15. Click Save Changes to save your edits. The system will re-validate edited fields against the schema.
16. If any edited field fails schema validation, an inline error message will appear. Correct the field value and save again.

6.3 Adding Reviewer Comments

Navigate to the Conclusion and Reviewer Fields section in the Output Viewer. Click the Add Reviewer Comment field and type your observations. Comments are timestamped and attributed to your user account. Multiple reviewers can add comments — they are displayed as a threaded list.

6.4 Approving the Standardised Output

> **NOTE**
> Approval should only be performed after all Low-Confidence (🔴) fields have been reviewed and either corrected or explicitly accepted with a justification note.

17. Ensure all red-confidence fields have been reviewed.
18. Click the Approve Report button at the top of the Output Viewer.
19. A confirmation dialogue will appear summarising the number of findings, confidence summary, and any unresolved low-confidence fields.
20. If there are unresolved low-confidence fields, you will be prompted to either resolve them or provide a justification for approving despite them.
21. Click Confirm Approval. The report status changes to Approved and a final version of the structured output (JSON, XML, and PDF summary) is generated and locked.

Approved outputs are digitally signed with a system-generated approval token tied to the approving user's account and timestamp.

6.5 Downloading the Standardised Output

From My Reports or the Output Viewer, click the Download button. Choose your preferred format:

Download Format	Use Case
JSON (.json)	Machine-readable structured output — primary format for system integration.
XML (.xml)	Alternative machine-readable format — suitable for legacy systems.
PDF Summary (.pdf)	Human-readable summary of the standardised report — suitable for sharing with stakeholders.
Full Package (.zip)	All of the above plus evidence attachments, traceability report, and original file hash record.

7. Troubleshooting

7.1 Common Issues and Solutions

Issue / Error	Possible Cause	Recommended Action
File upload fails immediately.	File format not supported or file is corrupted.	Check that the file is a supported format (Section 2.4). Try re-saving the file and re-uploading.
File size error.	File exceeds the 100 MB limit.	Compress the file or split the submission into multiple files. Contact Administrator for large-volume submissions.
Password-protected file error.	The uploaded PDF or DOCX is password-protected.	Remove the password protection before uploading. Never submit files with security restrictions.
Status stuck on 'Scanning'.	Malware scanning taking longer than usual or a scan alert was triggered.	Wait up to 15 minutes. If unresolved, contact the System Administrator. Do NOT re-submit.

Status shows 'Flagged'.	Malware scanner detected a potential threat in the file.	Do NOT re-submit. Immediately contact the System Administrator and report the source of the file.
Status shows 'Failed' after OCR.	File is a very low-quality scan that OCR cannot process adequately.	Re-scan the document at a higher resolution (minimum 300 DPI, preferably 600 DPI) and re-submit.
Many red-confidence fields in output.	Original report has very poor structure, non-standard terminology, or heavily image-based content.	Review and manually correct all red-confidence fields in the Reviewer Edit Mode. Consult Section 6.2.
Evidence not linked to findings.	Evidence was submitted as a separate file not linked to the main report, or in a non-standard format.	Re-submit with all files under one submission. Use Add Additional Files at upload stage.
Login fails.	Incorrect credentials or account locked after multiple failed attempts.	Verify username and password. After 5 failed attempts, the account is locked — contact Administrator.
Output download fails.	Session timeout or browser pop-up blocker.	Refresh the page and try again. Ensure pop-ups are not blocked. Log in again if session has expired.
Extracted CVE/CVSS appears incorrect.	Original report had non-standard formatting around CVE identifiers.	Verify against the original report using the Traceability Viewer. Edit the field manually in Review Mode.

7.2 Contacting Support

If your issue is not resolved by the steps above, contact the System Administrator through the following channels:

- Internal ticketing system: Navigate to Help → Submit Support Ticket from the Dashboard.
- Direct contact: Reach out to the Project Administrator or your designated system support contact.

When contacting support, always provide your Submission Reference Number (SRN), a description of the issue, and the exact error message or status shown on screen.

REMINDER

Do not share any report contents, extracted findings, or system screenshots outside of the authorised team. All support communications must remain within the confidential project channel.

8. Best Practices and Guidelines

8.1 Before Uploading

- Ensure the report is complete and finalised before submission. Partial reports may result in missing fields and low-confidence extractions.
- Remove any password protection from the document before uploading.
- If the report contains annexures in a separate Excel file or screenshots in a separate folder, include all of them in a single submission using Add Additional Files.
- Verify that the report is in a supported format. If the original is in an unsupported format (e.g., .ppt), convert it to PDF before submission.
- Record the SHA-256 hash displayed after upload and compare it with the hash of your local copy to confirm integrity.

8.2 During Review

- Always review all fields with Medium (🟡) or Low (🔴) confidence indicators before approving.
- Use the Traceability Viewer to verify each extracted value against the original source.
- Add reviewer comments for any ambiguous or noteworthy findings to assist future evaluators.
- Do not approve an output with unresolved red-confidence fields unless you have explicitly reviewed and accepted them with a documented justification.

8.3 Security Practices

- Always log out after your session. Do not leave your workstation unattended while logged in.
- Do not copy standardised output files to personal storage devices. All downloads must remain on authorised, secured project systems.
- Never share your Submission Reference Number with unauthorised personnel.
- Report any suspicious system behaviour (unexpected errors, unusual access requests) immediately to the Administrator.

9. Glossary

Term / Abbreviation	Definition
AI / ML	Artificial Intelligence / Machine Learning — used by the system for entity extraction and synonym mapping.
CVE	Common Vulnerabilities and Exposures — a standardised identifier for publicly known cybersecurity vulnerabilities.
CVSS	Common Vulnerability Scoring System — a standard for assessing the severity of vulnerabilities on a 0–10 scale.
CWE	Common Weakness Enumeration — a categorisation of software and hardware weakness types.
JSON	JavaScript Object Notation — a lightweight, human-readable data interchange format used for the structured output schema.
NLP	Natural Language Processing — AI techniques used to understand and process text from audit reports.
OCR	Optical Character Recognition — technology used to extract text from scanned documents and images.
Schema	A formal definition of the structure, fields, data types, and constraints of the standardised audit report format.
SHA-256	A cryptographic hash function used to generate a unique fingerprint of each uploaded file for integrity verification.
Source Traceability	The system feature that links every extracted field back to its specific location in the original uploaded document.
SRN	Submission Reference Number — a unique identifier assigned to each report submission.
VAPT	Vulnerability Assessment and Penetration Testing — a common type of cybersecurity audit.
XML	Extensible Markup Language — an alternative machine-readable format for the structured output schema.

10. Appendices

Appendix A — Standard Audit Report Template: Section Summary

The following table summarises the standard sections defined in the Cybersecurity Audit Report Template. M = Mandatory; O = Optional; D = Domain-Specific.

Section	Description	Type
Report Metadata	SRN, report date, version, file hash, schema version.	M
Audit Type	VAPT, Network, Mobile, Web Application, etc.	M
Audited Organisation Details	Name, contact, sector, location.	M
Auditing Agency Details	Agency name, accreditation, contact.	M
Audit Scope	Systems, networks, applications in scope.	M
Audit Objectives	Goals stated by the auditing agency.	M
Audit Methodology	Methods, approaches, testing types used.	M
Assets Covered	Specific IPs, hostnames, URLs, apps tested.	M
Exclusions and Limitations	What was out of scope or could not be tested.	O
Tools Used	List of tools and versions used during the audit.	M
Vulnerability Findings	Full structured findings with all sub-fields.	M
Recommendations	Remediation recommendations per finding.	M
Remediation Priority	High / Medium / Low per finding.	M
Compliance / Control Mapping	Relevant standards references.	O
Executive Summary	Management-level overview of findings.	M
Technical Summary	Technical overview and finding statistics.	M
Conclusion	Overall assessment and audit conclusion.	M
Reviewer Comments	Reviewer observations and notes.	O
Correction History	Track record of post-submission corrections.	O
Approval Status	Pending / Approved / Rejected.	M
VAPT-Specific Fields	Exploit path, attack vector, proof of concept.	D
Network Audit Fields	Network topology, firewall rules, routing analysis.	D
Mobile App Security Fields	Platform, version, permissions, binary analysis.	D
Web App Security Fields	Authentication mechanism, session management, OWASP mapping.	D

Appendix B — Severity Classification Reference

Severity Level	CVSS Score Range	Description
Critical	9.0 – 10.0	Immediate exploitation risk; could lead to full system compromise or data breach.
High	7.0 – 8.9	Significant risk; exploitation could cause major damage without immediate action.
Medium	4.0 – 6.9	Moderate risk; exploitation is possible under specific conditions.
Low	0.1 – 3.9	Minor risk; limited impact; should be addressed in normal patching cycles.
Informational	N/A	Observation only; no direct exploitation risk; improve security posture.

Appendix C — Quick Reference: Upload Checklist

- File is in a supported format (PDF, DOCX, TXT, XLSX, image, log).
- File is not password-protected.
- File size is under 100 MB (or split if larger).
- All related annexures and evidence files are attached in the same submission.
- Metadata fields (report title, audit type, organisation, agency, date) are correctly filled.
- Appropriate processing options (OCR, table extraction, evidence extraction) are selected.
- Submission Reference Number (SRN) has been noted after submission.

- SHA-256 hash has been recorded for integrity verification.

Appendix D — Output Download Checklist

- Processing status shows 'Completed'.
- All Medium and Low confidence fields have been reviewed.
- Reviewer comments have been added where applicable.
- Report has been Approved by an authorised Reviewer.
- Download format selected matches the intended use (JSON for integration, PDF for stakeholder sharing, Full Package for archiving).
- Downloaded file is stored only on authorised, secured project systems.